

Across Borders: The Second Attempt

跨越边界：第二次尝试

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The **second** attempt was built on a **large sheet** of paper with a **strict charter** beside it. “The committee must explain the plan to the **nation** in the **context** of the **war**,” the **technician** said. “We have **cash** for one month, a **licence** for one line, and a **grade** of patience that is nearly exhausted.” Their approach had to change, and they realized it together.

The **collective load** was carried by a **wagon**, a **tractor**, and a **portable radio**. “A **brand** is not a **blade**,” the **marine** said, “and a **grip** is not a **temple**.” A **duck** on the **deck**, a **candle** in the **lodge**, and a **crab** in the bucket: the **wild** harbour had every kind of cargo except a timetable.

The **extensive** survey had one fault: it measured **speed** and **mileage** but not the **subway** ride home. “A **pirate** on the **curb** can steal a bicycle faster than we can chart a **flood**,” the engineer said. “What we need is a **bumper** and a **sheet** of plywood, not another report.”

The **dove** on the roof, the **second watch** of the night, and the **sail** of the fishing boat marked the hours. “**Bondage** is a strong word,” Aisha said, “but a timetable that ignores the **elbow** of a crowded **deck** is a kind of **bondage**.” Their own committee could not explain that sentence to the ministry, so they printed it without explanation.

The film of the trial was late, as usual, and the short season was over. They had to obtain one more month, and they had to relate the new plan to the old one. “Speak plainly,” the committee chair said. “Understand that we do not own the road.” The stop, the walk, and the fly on the window were all in the final shot. The approach, the plan, the fact, and the film were all late; the committee had to explain, once more, how they had obtained the **licence** with their own cash and a short season. “We realize that a royal charter is not a plain **licence**,” she said. “We must speak to the people who walk and stop at the station.” The season was over, and the **second** attempt had one month left. A crate of **china** and a **meter** of cable were still on the **deck**.

中文翻译

第二次尝试建立在一大张纸上，旁边放着一部严格的章程。“委员会必须在战争的背景下向全国解释这个计划，”技师说，“我们有一个月的现金、一条线路的许可，以及一份几乎耗尽的耐心。”他们的做法必须改变，而他们一起意识到了这一点。

集体的负荷由一辆货车、一台拖拉机和一台便携收音机承担。“品牌不是刀刃，”那位海军陆战队员说，“而紧握不是庙宇。”甲板上的一只鸭子、客栈里的一支蜡烛、桶里的一只螃蟹：这个野性的港口拥有各种货物，唯独没有时刻表。

那份广泛的调查有一个缺陷：它测量了速度和英里数，却没有测回家坐地铁的那一段。“路缘上的海盜偷一辆自行车，比我们绘制一场洪水还快，”工程师说，“我们需要的是一个保险杠和一张胶合板，而不是又一份报告。”

屋顶上的鸽子、夜里第二班值守，以及渔船的帆标记着时间。“奴役是个很重的词，”艾莎说，“但一张忽视拥挤甲板上手肘的时刻表，就是一种奴役。”他们自己的委员会无法向部里解释这句话，于是他们不加解释地把它印了出来。

试行的影片照例迟了，而短暂的季节已经过去。他们必须再争取一个月，并且必须把新计划与旧计划联系起来。“说清楚点，”委员会主席说，“要明白我们并不拥有这条路。”那个车站、那段步行，以及窗上的那只苍蝇，都出现在最后的镜头里。方案、计划、事实和影片全都迟了；委员会不得不再次解释，他们是如何用自己的现金和一个短暂的季节拿到这张许可的。“我们明白，一份皇家特许状不是一张普通许可，”她说，“我们必须去和那些在车站步行、停留的人说话。”季节结束了，第二次尝试只剩下一个月。甲板上还放着一箱瓷器和一米电缆。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
large lɑ:dʒ POS: a	a. 大的, 大量的, 宽大的, 广博的; adv. 大大地, 夸大地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a garment size for a large person; a. above average in size or number or quantity or magnitude or extent; s. ...
second 'sekənd POS: n	n. 秒, 瞬间, 第二名, 支持者, 助手; a. 第二的, 其次的, 次要的, 附加的, 辅助的; num. 第二; vt. 当...助手, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. 1/60 of a minute; the basic unit of time adopted under the Systeme International d'Unites; n. following the...
war wɔ: POS: n	n. 战争, 战争状态, 战术, 军事, 冲突, 斗争, 竞争; vi. 进行战争, 作战, 打仗, 战斗; a. 战争的, 战时用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the waging of armed conflict against an enemy; n. a legal state created by a declaration of war and ended b...
watch wɒtʃ POS: n	n. 观察, 手表, 看守, 守护, 监视, 值班人; vt. 看, 注视, 照顾, 看守, 守护, 监视; vi. 观看, 注视, 守候 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small portable timepiece; n. a period of time (4 or 2 hours) during which some of a ship's crew are on du...
nation 'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 国家, 民族; [法] 民族, 国家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the people who live in a nation or country; n. United States prohibitionist who raided saloons and destroye...
radio 'reɪdiəʊ POS: n	n. 无线电, 收音机, 无线电报, 无线电广播, 无线电台; v. 用无线电发送 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. medium for communication; n. a communication system based on broadcasting electromagnetic waves; v. transmit...
fly flaɪ POS: n	n. 苍蝇, 两翼昆虫, 飞行; vi. 飞, 飞翔, 飘扬, 逃走; vt. 飞, 飞越, 使飘扬, 逃出; a. 敏捷的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. two-winged insects characterized by active flight; n. an opening in a garment that is closed by a zipper or...
context 'kɒntekst POS: n	n. 上下文, 背景, 来龙去脉; n. 上下文; [计] 上下文 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. discourse that surrounds a language unit and helps to determine its interpretation; n. the set of facts or...
cash kæʃ POS: n	n. 现金; vt. 兑现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. money in the form of bills or coins; n. prompt payment for goods or services in currency or by check; n. Uni...
speed spi:d POS: n	n. 速率, 速度, 迅速; vi. 加速, 超速, 快进; vt. 快速传送, 促进, 使加速; [计] 中央处理机速度设置程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. distance travelled per unit time; n. a rate (usually rapid) at which something happens; n. changing location...
wild waɪld POS: n	n. 荒野, 荒地; a. 野性的, 野蛮的, 野生的, 失控的, 任性的, 杂乱的, 轻率的, 狂热的, 疯狂的; adv. 狂暴地, 失控地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wild primitive state untouched by civilization; a. marked by extreme lack of restraint or control; a. in a...
grade greɪd POS: n	n. 等级, 年级, 阶段, 成绩, 程度, 坡度, 斜坡; vt. 分等, 分级, 评分; vi. 属于某等级, 逐渐变化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a relative position or degree of value in a graded group; n. the gradient of a slope or road or other surfa...
sheet ʃi:t POS: n	n. 床单, 张, 纸张, 印刷品, 裹尸布, 薄片; vt. 盖上被单, 遍布; vi. 大片落下; a. 片状的, 成薄片的; [计] 工作表 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any broad thin expanse or surface; n. paper used for writing or printing; n. bed linen consisting of a large...
china 'tʃaɪnə POS: n	n. 中国, 瓷器; a. 中国的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a communist nation that covers a vast territory in eastern Asia; the most populous country in the world; n. ...
licence 'laɪsəns POS: n	n. 执照, 许可证, 特许; vt. 许可, 特许, 认可 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n excessive freedom; lack of due restraint; n freedom to deviate deliberately from normally applicable rules o...
extensive ɪk'stensɪv POS: a	a. 广的, 广泛的, 多方面的; [经] 广大的, 扩大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. large in spatial extent or range or scope or quantity; a. of agriculture; increasing productivity by using...
load ləʊd POS: n	n. 负荷, 担子, 重担, 装载量, 负载, 工作量, 加载; vt. 装载, 装填, 使担负; vi. 装货, 上客, 装料; [计] 加载... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. weight to be borne or conveyed; n. a quantity that can be processed or transported at one time; n. an amount...
brand brænd POS: n	n. 商标, 牌子, 烙印; vt. 打烙印于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a recognizable kind; n. identification mark on skin, made by burning; n. a piece of wood that has been burne...
deck dek POS: n	n. 甲板, (汽车后部的)行李仓; vt. 装饰, 打扮, 装甲板; [计] 纸牌背面图案 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various platforms built into a vessel; n. street name for a packet of illegal drugs; n. a porch that...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
sail seil POS: n	n. 帆, 篷, 帆船, 航程, 帆状物; vi. 航行, 启航, 张帆而行; vt. 航行于, 驾船 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large piece of fabric (usually canvas fabric) by means of which wind is used to propel a sailing vessel; ...
meter 'mi:tə POS: n	n. 米, 公尺, 仪表, 计量器; vt. 以仪表计量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the basic unit of length adopted under the Systeme International d'Unites (approximately 1.094 yards); n. a...
charter 'tʃɑ:tə POS: n	n. 特许状, 执照, 宪章; vt. 特许, 发给特许执照 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document incorporating an institution and specifying its rights; includes the articles of incorporation...
strict strikt POS: a	a. 严厉的, 绝对的, 详尽的, 严格的, 精确的; [法] 严格的, 精确的, 绝对的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s rigidly accurate; allowing no deviation from a standard; s (of rules) stringently enforced; a characterized b...
collective kə'lektiv POS: a	a. 集体的, 聚集的, 共同的; [医] 集体的, 集合的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. members of a cooperative enterprise; a. forming a whole or aggregate; s. set up on the principle of collecti...
blade bleid POS: n	n. 叶片, 刀锋, 刀口, 剑; [医] 页[片], 叶片, 刀片, 刀刃, 刀口 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. especially a leaf of grass or the broad portion of a leaf as distinct from the petiole; n. a dashing young...
grip grip POS: n	n. 紧握, 柄, 握力, 握手方式, 手提包, 掌握, 支配, 控制; vt. 抓紧, 抱住, 吸住, 掌握; vi. 握牢, 有吸引力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the friction between a body and the surface on which it moves (as between an automobile tire and the road)...
temple templ POS: n	n. 圣堂, 庙宇, 教堂, 礼拜堂, 太阳穴, 鬓角; [医] 颞颥, 颞部 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. place of worship consisting of an edifice for the worship of a deity; n. the flat area on either side of th...
elbow 'elbəu POS: n	n. 手肘, 弯头, 扶手; v. 用手肘推开, 推挤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. hinge joint between the forearm and upper arm and the corresponding joint in the forelimb of a quadruped; n...
duck dak POS: n	n. 鸭子; vi. 没入水中, 闪避; vt. 猛按...入水, 躲避 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. small wild or domesticated web-footed broad-billed swimming bird usually having a depressed body and short...
marine mə'ri:n POS: n	n. 舰队, 水兵, 海景画; a. 海的, 海产的, 海底的, 船舶的, 海运的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a member of the United States Marine Corps; n. a soldier who serves both on shipboard and on land; a. of or...
flood fləd POS: n	n. 洪水, 大量之水, 涨潮; vt. 淹没, 使泛滥, 注满; vi. 被淹, 溢出, 涌进 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the rising of a body of water and its overflowing onto normally dry land; n. an overwhelming number or amou...
candle 'kændl POS: n	n. 蜡烛; vt. 对着光检查 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. stick of wax with a wick in the middle; n. the basic unit of luminous intensity adopted under the Systeme l...
wagon 'wæɡən POS: n	n. 四轮马车, 货车; [法] 囚车, 马车, 运货车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various kinds of wheeled vehicles drawn by an animal or a tractor; n. a child's four-wheeled toy car...
technician tek'nɪʃən POS: n	n. 技师; [化] 技师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone whose occupation involves training in a specific technical process; n. someone known for high skill...
crab kræb POS: n	n. 螃蟹, 偏航, 脾气乖戾的人, 沙果; vi. 捕蟹, 偏航, 发牢骚; vt. 使偏航, 抱怨, 破坏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. decapod having eyes on short stalks and a broad flattened carapace with a small abdomen folded under the t...
lodge lɒdʒ POS: n	n. 小屋, 门房, 支部, 旅舍, 分会; vi. 临时住宿, 倒伏, 寄宿, 投宿; vt. 安顿, 容纳, 提出, 把...射入, 存放 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. English physicist who studied electromagnetic radiation and was a pioneer of radiotelegraphy (1851-1940); n...
subway 'səbwei POS: n	n. 地铁, 地道; vi. 乘地铁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an electric railway operating below the surface of the ground (usually in a city); n an underground tunnel o...
portable 'pɔ:təbl POS: a	a. 可携带的, 可搬运的, 可移动的; [计] 可移植的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small light typewriter; usually with a case in which it can be carried; a. easily or conveniently transpo...
tractor 'træktə POS: n	n. 牵引器, 拖拉机, 拉纸器; [计] 进纸器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wheeled vehicle with large wheels; used in farming and other applications; n. a truck that has a cab but...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
curb kə:b POS: n	n. 抑制, 勒马绳, 边石; vt. 抑制, 束缚, 勒住 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an edge between a sidewalk and a roadway consisting of a line of curbstones (usually forming part of a gut...
pirate 'paɪərət POS: n	n. 海盗, 盗印者, 侵犯专利权者; vt. 盗印, 掠夺, 翻印; vi. 做海盗, 从事劫掠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who robs at sea or plunders the land from the sea without having a commission from any sovereign n...
dove dʌv POS: n	n. 鸽子; dive的过去式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of numerous small pigeons; n. someone who prefers negotiations to armed conflict in the conduct of fore...
mileage 'maɪlɪdʒ POS: n	n. 英里数; [经] 运费(按英里计算的) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. distance measured in miles; n. the ratio of the number of miles traveled to the number of gallons of gasoli...
bumper 'bʌmpə POS: n	n. 缓冲器, 满杯; a. 大胜利的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a glass filled to the brim (especially as a toast); n. a mechanical device consisting of bars at either end...
bondage 'bɒndɪdʒ POS: n	n. 奴役, 束缚; [法] 束缚, 监禁, 奴隶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being under the control of a force or influence or abstract power; n. the state of being under...